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MAJOR CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS IN INDIA

Dance	State	Description
Bharatnatyam	Tamil Nadu	It is a delightful combination of four elements i.e. expression, music, beats, and dance. The accompanying music in Bharatnatyam is classical Carnatic. The costumes are similar to Indian sarees with vibrant colours and made of Kanchipuram silk and Banaras silk.
Kathak	Uttar Pradesh	The word Kathak is originated from the word Katha which means storytelling. Traditionally this dance was more religious in nature, typically narrating the stories of Radha and Krishna. The dancers dance to the rhythm of table or pakhawaj
Kathakali	Kerala	Kathakali means story play; hence the stories of Ramayana and Mahabharata act as a source for a lot of performances. This form of dance is known for its heavy, intense makeup and costumes.
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh	It is a combination of speech, Abhinaya (mime) and pure dance. Kuchipudi performance is more like a dance drama where dancers play different roles based on the drama content.
Manipuri	Manipur	The main characteristics of this dance are colourful decoration and costumes, charming music, gentle and swaying petal-soft foot movements and delicacy of performance. This traditional dance is mainly inspired by the rich culture of Manipur.
Mohiniattam	Kerala	The word Mohiniattam derives its meaning from the word Mohini, which means beautiful women and 'attam' which means dance. Thus, this form of dance represents a beautiful feminine grace. These dances are based on love and emotion themes.
Odissi	Odisha	Performed by 'Maharis' or female temple servants, this dance form has a close association with the temples and temple sculptures. Odissi stands out from other forms of dances because of its Tribhangi posture, dealing with three body parts, i.e. head, bust, and torso.
Sattriya	Assam	It is an art which represents dance-drama performances with a unique combination of hand gestures, footwork, expressions, and body movements. Most of the themes of dance related to Ram and Sita or Krishna and Radha.

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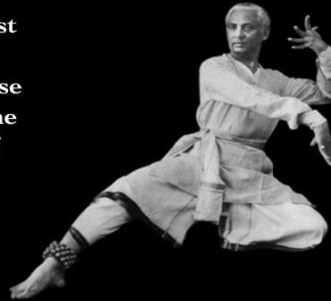
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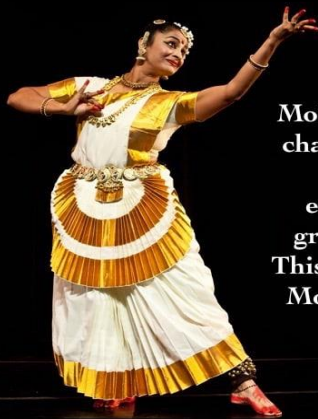
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Bharatanatyam is considered one of the oldest classical styles of dance. Featuring strong and precise movements, this style is one of the most prominent of Indian dance styles, practiced by millions worldwide.



Kuchipudi is a classical dance style which draws its roots from a folksy drama performance background, with graceful movements and dramatic storytelling. This style is characterized by acts of extreme balancing, such as dancing atop a brass plate!



Mohiniyattam is a dance style characterized by its slow and graceful movements, emulating the beauty and grace of the feminine form. This style draws its name from Mohini, the female avatar of the Hindu god Vishnu.



Kathak finds its historic roots with ancient storytellers from Northern India. The incredibly fast-paced yet graceful spins and intricate footwork of dancers are key features of this dance style.

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Odissi originates as a performance dance in the Hindu temples of Northern India, and this style has been traditionally practiced by both women and young boys. The style places special emphasis on acrobatic acts and graceful movements of the hips and wrists.



Kathakali is a prominent dance form from the state of Kerala, characterized by the intense makeup and costumes of dancers. The name Kathakali literally translates to "story play", and it focuses on dramatic retellings of tales from ancient Hindu epics.



Sattriya is a style of dance traditionally performed by male monks in Hindu monasteries (sattras). Dances of this style mainly incorporate stories of the god Vishnu, particularly those of his avatar Krishna.



Manipuri is a dance style which incorporates highly energetic and active movements with its male dancers and gentle, graceful movement with its female dancers. Unlike with the other classical dance forms, Manipuri dancers do not wear bells on their feet, putting an emphasis on soft footwork instead.

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